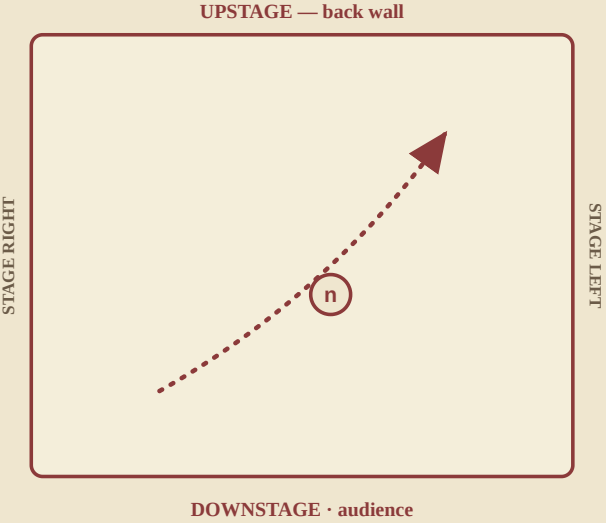


Movement & Blocking Maps

Top-down staging plans — *Six Characters in Search of an Author* · Village Players, Lausanne · dir. Kiarash Jamshidi



Every plan is seen from above. The audience sits at the bottom edge.

THE COMPANY ON STAGE

- F** The Father
- M** The Mother
- SD** The Step-Daughter
- S** The Son
- MG** The Manager
- P1** Player 1
- P2** Player 2
- P3** Player 3
- MP** Madame Pace
- PN** Pianist

THE TWO STAGE OBJECTS

- BOY** Boy-chair (the Boy)
- CH** Child-bundle (the Child)

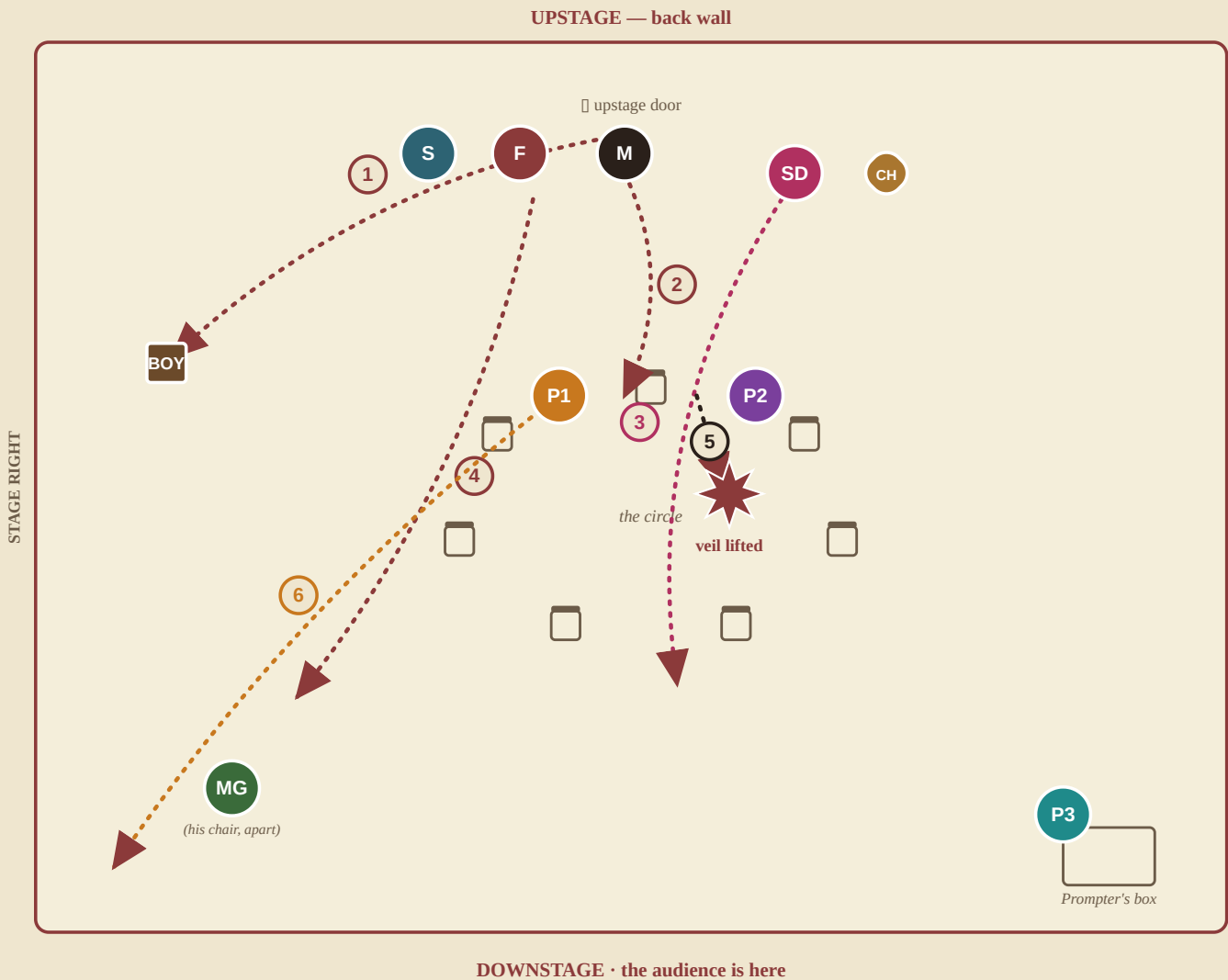
SYMBOLS

- a movement, in order
- a chair (Act One circle)
- the gunshot / a sudden event
- the “shower” light column (Act Two)

Read each act's plan with its numbered key on the right; the per-character journey is the last page.

Act One — The Family

A bare stage, a circle of chairs. The rehearsal is interrupted; the Six walk in.

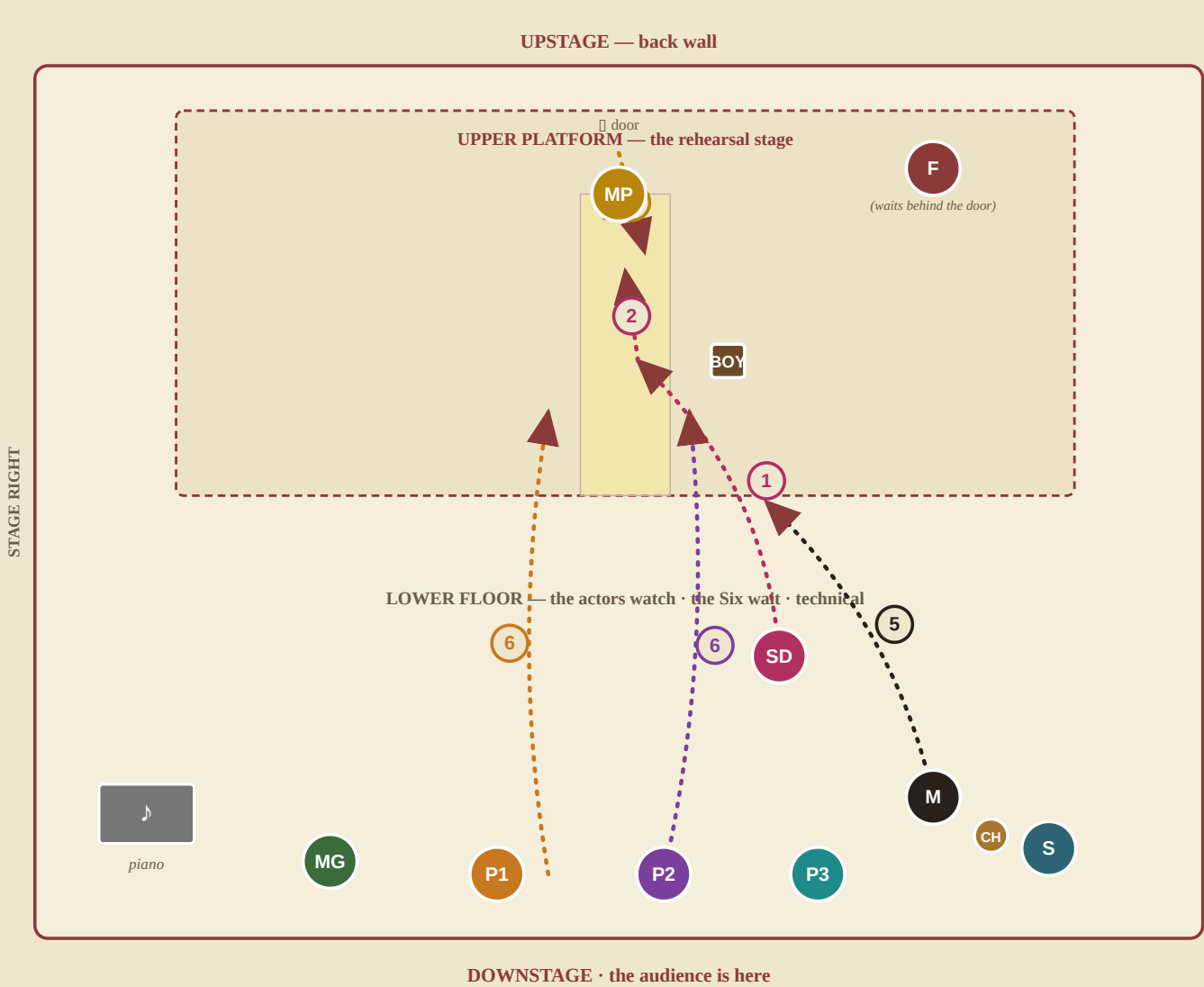


Movement key

- 1 The Door-keeper carries the Boy-chair in from the upstage door and sets it at the stage-right edge.
- 2 The Six enter from the upstage door in a tenuous light and advance to centre.
- 3 The Step-Daughter comes downstage with the Child-bundle — sings and dances, then taunts the Father.
- 4 The Father crosses to the Manager (at his chair, apart) and pleads to be staged.
- 5 The Mother faints centre; the Father lifts her veil against her will.
- 6 The company recedes to the wings and becomes the on-stage audience; the bargain — light drifts amber to deep red.

Act Two — The Theatre

Two levels. Performing is up; watching is down. The line between them is the platform's edge.

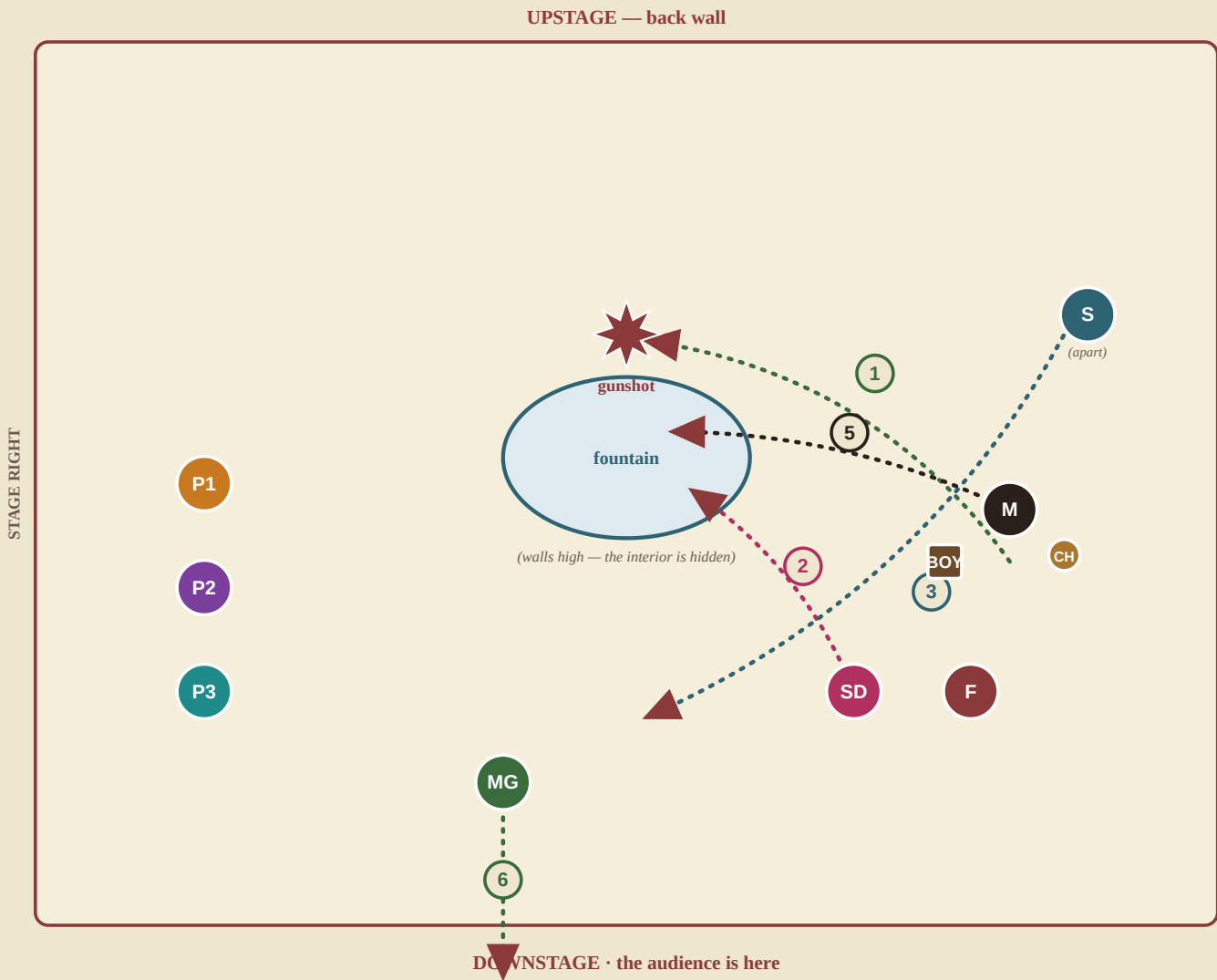


Movement key

- 1 The Step-Daughter erupts from the lower floor up onto the platform, dragging the Boy-chair, carrying the Child-bundle.
- 2 She steps into the shower for her solo monologue, and takes the revolver from the coat on the Boy-chair.
- 3 Conjured: the upstage door opens and Madame Pace enters onto the platform, into the shower — the shop scene.
- 4 The Father waits behind the upstage door, ready to enter the scene on cue.
- 5 The Mother, on the lower floor, erupts upward at Madame Pace — "You old devil!" — her voice crossing up.
- 6 The Leading Lady and Leading Man climb up to replay the scene (the doubled scene); the Mother is forced to watch; the Machinist drops the curtain by accident.

Act Three — The Question

A bare stage; one fountain basin. Family stage-right, the company stage-left, the Manager centre.



Movement key

- 1 The Manager picks up the Boy-chair himself and carries it behind the fountain — the moment he stops being audience and becomes accessory.
- 2 The Step-Daughter crosses to the basin, bends over it, and lowers the Child-bundle into the water.
- 3 The Son comes downstage-centre to narrate the drowning he could not stop — his one continuous speech.
- 4 Blackout. A real gunshot from behind the basin, where the Boy-chair is.
- 5 The Mother rises and reaches — first for the Child-bundle in the basin, then for the Boy-chair behind it — and cannot hold both.
- 6 The Manager looks at the place where the Boy-chair stood, says “To hell with it all,” and walks out the way a man leaves a theatre.

Where everyone goes — the journey in one view

CHARACTER	ACT ONE — THE FAMILY	ACT TWO — THE THEATRE	ACT THREE — THE QUESTION
The Father	Enters with the Six (upstage); crosses to plead with the Manager; lifts the Mother's veil.	On the lower floor; waits behind the upstage door of the platform to play the shop scene.	Seated right-front; argues the reality debate centre; pinned, ends in stillness.
The Mother	Enters with the Six; faints centre; veil lifted against her will.	On the lower floor; erupts upward at Madame Pace; forced to watch the doubled scene.	Seated right with both children; rises and reaches for Child-bundle then Boy-chair — cannot hold both.
The Step-Daughter	Enters with the Child-bundle; comes downstage to sing and taunt; drives the exposure.	Erupts up onto the platform; solo in the shower; plays the shop scene with Madame Pace.	Crosses to the basin, lowers the Child-bundle in; then runs, and is gone.
The Son	Enters with the Six; stays at the edge, refusing.	On the lower floor, apart; will not go up.	Isolated stage-right; comes downstage to narrate the drowning — his one continuous speech.
The Manager	At his own chair, apart; receives the Father; runs the room.	On the lower floor; casts and directs the doubled scene from below.	Centre, standing; picks up the Boy-chair and sets it behind the fountain; then walks out.
Player 1	Leading Man in the chair circle; Door-keeper carries in the Boy-chair; recedes to the wings.	Climbs to the platform as the Leading Man in the doubled scene; the Machinist drops the curtain.	Seated stage-left with the company; watches.
Player 2	Leading Lady in the circle; gives her hat; recedes to the wings.	Climbs to the platform as the Leading Lady (doubled scene); walks off, offended.	Seated stage-left; watches.
Player 3	Youngest; near the Prompter's box; recedes to the wings with the company.	On the lower floor; the company's witness as the scene turns.	Seated stage-left; the audience's mirror.
Madame Pace	— (not yet present).	Conjured through the upstage door of the platform; into the shower; plays the shop, then exits.	— (her scene is over).
Boy-chair	Carried in by the Door-keeper; set at the stage-right edge.	Dragged up onto the platform; the revolver taken from its coat.	Carried by the Manager behind the fountain; the gunshot comes from there.
Child-bundle	Carried on by the Step-Daughter; held centre.	In the Step-Daughter's arms through the monologue and the shop.	Lowered into the fountain basin; the drowning is hidden by its walls.